



AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)

Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08

SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

Section 18A application pending

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www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Eskom Development Foundation NPC × ASCO

Community Climate Action and Sustainable Livelihoods
Initiative

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: A confirmed South African community where Eskom operates, preferably a rural or underserved municipality selected with ESDEF; exact province, district and site to be proposed only after ESDEF confirms geographic fit.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Eskom Development Foundation NPC** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Community Climate Action and Sustainable Livelihoods Initiative**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is a South African Non-Profit Company and a SARS-approved Public Benefit Organisation, reference number **930092287**. ASCO's **Section 18A application is currently pending**; ASCO does not represent that it has Section 18A approval or that current donations are Section 18A tax deductible.

The proposal in one sentence: Community Climate Action and Sustainable Livelihoods Initiative in A confirmed South African community where Eskom operates, preferably a rural or underserved municipality selected with ESDEF; exact province, district and site to be proposed only after ESDEF confirms geographic fit., benefiting Proposed: 200 low-income community residents, prioritising women, youth and people with disabilities, with final numbers and demographic split validated through the application baseline. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Eskom Development Foundation NPC's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting

R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable

Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu

Executive Director

African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)

PBO Reference: 930092287

Tel: +27 76 757 5773

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The proposed project

Project title Community Climate Action and Sustainable Livelihoods Initiative	Implementation period Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.
Location A confirmed South African community where Eskom operates, preferably a rural or underserved municipality selected with ESDEF; exact province, district and site to be proposed only after ESDEF confirms geographic fit.	Target beneficiaries Proposed: 200 low-income community residents, prioritising women, youth and people with disabilities, with final numbers and demographic split validated through the application baseline.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: establish 4 community-managed environmental-action sites (for example food-security, greening or waste-reduction sites), subject to technical and land-use approval.
- Proposed: train 40 local participants in environmental stewardship, resource efficiency and sustainable livelihoods.
- Proposed: deliver 8 practical community workshops and 2 school/community awareness events on sustainability and responsible resource use.
- Proposed: create 4 site-level maintenance and monitoring plans, with quarterly reporting for 12 months.
- Proposed: provide an auditable R100,000 expenditure plan supported by three quotations and beneficiary/output evidence.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need** → **practical intervention** → **measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple

evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

Evidence discipline: All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Eskom Development Foundation NPC?

ASCO is a South African NPC with SARS-approved PBO reference 930092287, so its legal form is directionally consistent with ESDEF's stated requirement that applicants be registered non-profit organisations. A proposed R100,000 community-development and environmental-action project could cautiously fit ESDEF's community upliftment and historically documented energy/sustainability or environmental interests, especially if it serves a clearly defined community in an area where Eskom operates, has measurable public benefits, and avoids commercial sponsorship. This is only a potential alignment: ESDEF must confirm that the current mandate accepts the specific environmental activities and budget.

Verified company context

- ESDEF states that it advances socio-economic development and community upliftment across South Africa, with programmes focused on education, economic development and community upliftment.
- Eskom's 2026 Integrated Report identifies Eskom Development Foundation NPC as the group's non-profit company delivering corporate social investment programmes.
- The Foundation's official application page says it works at provincial and national levels and reports more than 1.2 million individuals uplifted in FY25; this is an ESDEF-reported aggregate, not a result attributable to ASCO.
- The official FAQ states that ESDEF donations are for registered non-profit organisations; individuals and private companies are not eligible, and sponsorships are outside the ESDEF mandate.
- The official application form requires organisation/CIPC registration details, physical province and municipal location, beneficiary demographics, a signed and dated application letter, latest three-month stamped bank statement and three quotations.
- The application form lists all nine South African provinces, indicating national geographic coverage, while the historical Foundation report says programmes primarily target communities where Eskom operates.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	R100,000	Equals the proposed request.

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding

Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding

Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership

Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support

Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Submit through the official ESDEF application form: <https://www.eskom.co.za/esdef/application-form/> . For clarification, use the official ESDEF email csi@eskom.co.za. ESDEF's page indicates that the registered non-profit organisation must apply directly; ASCO should not treat submission as approval.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- ASCO's Section 18A application is pending; do not describe ASCO as Section 18A-approved.
- ESDEF's current public pages do not establish that every environmental project is currently fundable, nor do they promise funding or a particular amount.
- The historical Foundation report is from 2019 and should not be used as proof of current priorities without confirmation.
- The official exclusions include unregistered or profit-making organisations, individuals, most religious organisations, fundraising/table sponsorships, and projects inconsistent with Eskom policies or South African law.
- Application does not guarantee approval; ESDEF may verify information through a site visit and requires governance/compliance approval.
- The proposal should confirm ASCO's CIPC registration number, project site, land/community permissions, safeguarding and environmental compliance, detailed budget, quotations, monitoring plan and beneficiary counts before submission.
- No existing ASCO-Eskom partnership, completed ASCO results or Eskom commitment has been verified.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Eskom Development Foundation NPC** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu

Executive Director

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. <https://www.eskom.co.za/esdef/>
2. <https://www.eskom.co.za/esdef/how-to-apply/>
3. <https://www.eskom.co.za/esdef/application-form/>
4. <https://www.eskom.co.za/esdef/frequently-asked-questions/>
5. <https://www.eskom.co.za/esdef/contact/>
6. https://www.eskom.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2021/02/Eskom_2019_Foundation_report.pdf
7. <https://www.eskom.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/Eskom-integrated-report-2026.pdf>

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.